

Stuxnet affecting Indian systems

xStuxnet, a Windows based worm which affects the programmable logic controllers in industrial setups has already affected 10,000 Indian systems

MS using ARM power

According to a Bloomberg report Microsoft is developing a Windows OS to run on ARM chip architecture

Opera 11. Finally!

Opera's latest version brings a whole new way of managing tabs – a feature called “Tab stacking”. This feature gives tab management another dimension, as you are able to group tabs together in a stack. These grouped tabs can be handled like a single tab. Tab stacks can be expanded, collapsed and unstacked. For more about this feature, you can check out our preview of the beta build – it hasn't changed feature-wise since then.

Another great feature in Opera 11 is extension support. Opera has added a new extension mechanism in this version that allows developers to add features to the browser. Additionally, Opera users can now download extensions from the new Opera extensions web site hosted at addons.opera.com. Some popular browser extensions such

as LastPass and YouTube video downloader and ad blockers are already available, and there are now hundreds of extensions for Opera fans to choose from.

This version also features changes to the address field, which aims to reduce the amount of unnecessary data shown, and give you information about your security and connectivity status in a single glance. The browser now also has a visual cuing system that helps you understand mouse gestures. Also, Opera now has a setting that allows you to change the default behaviour of browser plugins, which can now be set to load on demand rather than automatically.

Opera 11 is available to download for Windows, Linux and Mac OSX, from the Opera web-site. What's more, the new version is also a 30 per cent smaller file to download. **d**

H.264 video comes to Firefox via Microsoft

Microsoft has shown its commitment to HTML5 in Internet Explorer already, with their countless demos and support in their upcoming IE9 browser, however it seems their support extends beyond Internet Explorer.

Microsoft has released a new add-on for Firefox that will make the browser capable of playing back H.264 video by tapping into the codecs installed on the system. It uses the Windows Media Player plug-in to play back video. Obviously it will work only on Windows, only Windows 7 in fact.

The add-on looks for instances of HTML5 video, and replaces the video with an instance of the Windows Media

player plug-in, pointed to the same video source file. Since the video is not actually playing in the browser itself, but in a plug-in, this has no advantages over just using the Flash Player.

Mozilla has been stringent about not supporting H.264 for HTML5 video in Firefox, and for good reason. While H.264 is popularly supported as an HTML5 video format and supported as such in Google Chrome and Apple Safari, it is in fact not part of the HTML5 standard, which is still mute when it comes to a standard video format for the web. H.264 has considerable licensing restrictions that make it not only the wrong choice as a format for the open web, but also expensive for companies such as Mozilla to use in their browser. It is another matter entirely for Google, which has no dearth of money, or for Apple and Microsoft, both of whom are licensors of patents used in H.264, and thus stand to gain from its adoption.

Mozilla, and Opera Software have instead decided to stand behind WebM and Theora as future standards for the web. In any case WebM is a better contender for the format of choice on the web in the future than H.264 due to its open nature.

If you are looking for the converse, i.e. HTML5 support in Internet Explorer, that too exists in the form of a codec pack by Xiph – the creators of Ogg. This codec pack includes an optional component that adds support for the HTML5 video tag, with support for WebM / VP8 and Ogg Theora video, as an ActiveX plug-in for Internet Explorer. **d**

Facebook launches “modern messaging system” with a consolidated inbox

Mark Zuckerberg recently named Time Magazine's Person of the Year, has had busy 2010. In the closing stages of the year, he announced a “modern messaging system”, which will allow users to have a unified “social inbox” for their email, chat, Facebook messages, IM and SMS, along with consolidated history for each contact. Zuckerberg emphasised that this was not an “email killer”, and that any email service could be used. Users will also be able to register for a @facebook.com

email address.

The messaging system's support for SMS precludes the need for an app, though of course to view the inbox natively new official apps for various platforms will be released in the near future. IMAP support will also be arriving shortly. The entire messaging system will take a while to rollout globally, with a timescale of a few months.

Zuckerberg spoke about how this was the first major step towards achieving Facebook's vision of the future of communication, and how based

on feedback from high school kids they decided to make it less “formal”, and instead, focus on creating a system that was “seamless, informal, immediate, personal, simple, minimal, and short.”

For all this to fit inside the Facebook ecology, an unusually large team (for Facebook) of 15 engineers supposedly “completely rebuilt the [messaging] infrastructure”, replacing the previous Cassandra system with “hBase”, which was developed by working closely with the open source community. **d**